[Metric]
A-A-87C
May 13, 1996
Superseding
A-A-87B
February 20, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCILS, WAX CHINA & GLASS MARKING
SPIRAL-PAPER-FORM

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for use by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers paper wrapped, waxed base pencils for writing on glossy surface materials.

2. **Classification:**

Type:	I - Thick Marking Core
	II - Thin Marking Core

3. **Salient Characteristics:**

3.1 The marking core for both types shall be a mixture of wax, extender, and pigments. Pencils shall be not less than 15.9 cm (6.25 inches) in length.

3.2 The marking core diameter for type I pencils shall be not less than .47 cm (.185 inches) and no more than .51 cm (.21 inches) with a minimum breaking strength of 2,100 grams.

3.3 The marking core diameter for type II pencils shall be not less than .4 cm (.157 inches) and no more than .42 cm (.165 inches) with a minimum breaking strength of 1,450 grams.

3.4 The marking cores for both types shall be in one piece and shall be of the color specified in the contract or order. Additionally, the cores shall be spiral and tightly wrapped with paper in accordance with normal commercial practices.

3.5 The pencils shall be furnished in the following colors: Red, White, Black, Yellow, Orange, Green, Blue, Purple, and Brown as specified in the order or contract.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Division, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3.6 The paper wrap shall be scored at intervals such as to provide for the easy removal of a strip of paper to further expose the marking core. A suitable starting method shall be provided for each strip to facilitate removal. The outer layer of the paper wrap shall be finished to approximate the color of the marking core.

3.7 Workmanship: Pencils shall produce continuous, clearly visible marks, free from chips and crumbs, and marks shall remain clearly legible, with no visible color change when subjected to high temperature. Additionally, the cores shall show no evidence of slippage during normal use and paper strips shall be easily removed without tearing or delaminations.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Examination and Testing.

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they will be allowed for visual and dimensional sampling.

5.1.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one pencil of either type. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

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5.1.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional defects shall be S-1 with a AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for performance testing shall be S-4 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5.2 Performance Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 23°C ± 1.1° C (73.5° F ± 2° F).

5.2.1 Point Breaking Strength. The core point break strength shall be conducted using a platform scale, the platform of which is smooth, and any suitable holding device which will maintain the pencil at a 45° angle to the platform and will permit uniform downward pressure of the pencil. Pencils shall have a square-cut, unsharpened tip extending 17.5 mm ± 4 mm (0.687 inches ± 0.062 inch) from the lowest point of the paper wrap. The pencil shall extend 3.2 cm to 3.8 cm (1.250 inches to 1.5 inches) beneath the holder and shall touch the platform. Exert uniform downward pressure and take reading at instant of breaking.

5.2.2 Legibility. Determine legibility and stability by inscribing six 12.7 mm (0.50 inch high letters and numbers on the side of a glass beaker. Place the beaker in an oven at 300 degrees ± 5° F for 1 hour. Remove from oven, allow to cool to room temperature, and examine. Core marking shall be clearly legible, with no visible color change.

5.2.3 Marking Characteristics. Determine acceptability of marking characteristics by drawing straight lines and zig zag marks consisting of short straight lines forming sharp angles on the following glossy surface materials: glass, aluminum, cellulose acetate tape, and glazed white porcelain. Examine markings for chips and crumbs, and pencil core for slippage.

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Source of Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

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7.2 National Stock Number Listing (NSN). The following is a list of Nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

Pencil:

7510-00-164-8920	7510-00-268-9483
7510-00-174-3205	7510-00-275-7212
7510-00-181-7267	7510-00-282-3375
7510-00-240-1525	7510-00-282-7894
7510-00-240-1526	7510-00-436-5210
7510-00-264-4612	7510-00-584-4066
7510-00-264-4613	

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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